

your requests (and do remember that these are *requests*, since the seller can say no to any of them). You don't want to simply say something vague like, "Seller to clean gutters, cut down dead tree, and fix broken light switch in bedroom."

Instead, make sure everything is specified and numbered like so:

1. Seller to have gutters cleaned and all debris removed by June 14, 2021.
2. Seller to have dead tree on the eastern side of the front yard cut down and the wood hauled away by XYZ Tree Service no later than June 14, 2021.
3. Seller to provide a credit at closing of \$1,000 for missing GFCI outlets in kitchen and broken light switch in pink bedroom.

There is nothing ambiguous about these requests, and there's a specific date by which the work must be done. You want the report to leave absolutely nothing up to question. Though your agent should know to be as specific as possible, you should double-check their work when they send you the inspection objection for approval.

R.E.S.P.E.C.T.

One time, a friend of ours was selling her house with a very long inspection deadline. The buyers had the inspection performed very early in the timeline, but they waited until the last minute before their deadline to drop the inspection objection notice on her. At the time, she was moving out of state and arranging a cross-country moving van, and she thought that since so much time had elapsed, they weren't going to ask for any repairs.

Instead, they submitted a massive list of repairs—and frankly, some of them were quite ridiculous—and demanded everything be done in two days. The seller felt bullied and intimidated.

Real estate transactions are often contentious, but they don't have to be. Other than the fact that the seller wants more money and you want to pay less of it (both of which are very reasonable desires), everyone is on the same page. They want to sell their house; you want to buy it. Both parties want the transaction to go as smoothly as possible.

If the inspection has revealed issues with the home, share the necessary repairs with the seller sooner rather than later. Some agents will say that